

2008 NEWSMAKER THE TERRORIST

Prophets of DOOM

A glossary of terror groups who have taken their war against India to the hinterland



HAFIZ M SAEED

Lashkar-e-Toiba

(LeT)

Founded in 1986

Chief HAFIZ M. SAEED

Attacks Mumbai 26/11 and Akshardham in September 2002

THE biggest and best organised of the anti-India terror groups and with a manifesto professing disintegration of the country, the LeT was founded to fight the Soviet army in Afghanistan. From the early 1990s, it began infiltrating hundreds of Pakistani fighters to shore up a flagging militant movement and post-Kargil

it pioneered the concept of 'fidayeen' or suicide gunmen, engaging the security forces in firefights to draw media and world attention. Closely allied with the Pakistani military and functioning under the guise of a now-banned social organisation Jamaat-ud-Dawa, the LeT is the sword arm of the ISI's operations in the Indian hinterland. The LeT draws its cadre from Pakistan's Punjab province and trains them in camps near Muzaffarabad, the capital of Pakistan occupied Kashmir, before infiltrating them across the Line of Control in Jammu and Kashmir.

■ Very high risk ■ High risk ■ Significant risk ■ Low risk

Jaish-e-Mohammad

(JeM)

Founded in 2000

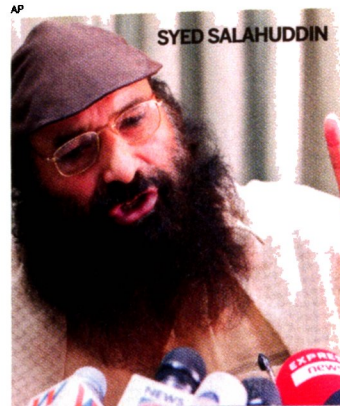
Chief MAULANA MASOOD AZHAR

Attacks Parliament in December 2001 and Ayodhya in July 2005

FOUNDED by Maulana Masood Azhar a month after he was released for the passengers of the hijacked IC-814, the JeM is the newest terror organisation. The Jaish and the LeT now form one of the two groups used by the ISI in its war against India. Its biggest operation outside the Kashmir Valley was the attack on Parliament on December 13, 2001 which nearly triggered off war between the two countries. Azhar operates out of a fortified compound in Bahawalpur in Punjab province of Pakistan and is one of the three people India wants from Pakistan, along with Dawood and Tiger Memon. The group increasingly relies on surrogate bases within Nepal, Bangladesh and the Middle East to move cadres and finances.



MAULANA MASOOD AZHAR



SYED SALAHUDDIN

Harkat-ul-Jihad-i-Islam

(HuM)

Founded in 1989

Chief QARI SAIFULLAH AKHTAR

Attacks Assam 2008 blasts, Shramjeevi Express blasts

ANOTHER Pakistan-based terror group founded during the Afghan resistance of the Soviet occupation, the HuM quickly transformed itself into yet another group targeting India in Jammu and Kashmir. Its eastern affiliate set up in 1992—the HuM (Bangladesh) comprising Bangladeshi veterans of the Afghan war—was declared a foreign terrorist organisation by the US State Department this year. With its tentacles extending from Karachi, Dhaka and Saudi Arabia, HuM involves the underworlds of Mumbai, Gujarat and West Bengal to supply men, material and finance using hawala channels. In recent years, the HuM (B) has emerged as the ideal candidate for the ISI's second front in the east and in its terror campaign against India. Its activists have co-ordinated their attacks with the LeT, SIMI and the JeM.